

Characterization of Lightweight CNN Architectures with INT8 Quantization for Poultry Fecal Disease Detection on Edge Devices

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Abstract—Poultry fecal disease detection with deep learning achieves high accuracy, but prior work largely targets cloud inference with heavy models that are impractical on farms. This paper presents a systematic characterization of three lightweight convolutional neural network architectures—MobileNetV2, ShuffleNetV2, and EfficientNet-B0—for classifying poultry fecal images into four disease categories: Coccidiosis, Salmonellosis, Newcastle Disease, and Healthy. We use the Machuve *et al.* dataset via HuggingFace `Dannyo/poultry-fecal-f1` (8,770 images: 5,614/1,402/1,754 train/val/test; 6,812 in Zenodo 4628934) and evaluate each model under INT8 dynamic PTQ (ONNX Runtime) on an Intel i5-12400F (200 runs, 10 warmup) and a Raspberry Pi 5 (Cortex-A76, ONNX Runtime 1.29.0, 96 thread/batch configs). All three models exceed 97% FP32 test accuracy (EfficientNet-B0 98.18%; MobileNetV2 1.85 ms, 540.8 FPS on x86). INT8 increases latency by 6.4–30.1 $\times$ on x86 and 1.9–2.8 $\times$ on RPi5; on RPi5, INT8 scales by only 1.1–1.2 $\times$ (1 $\rightarrow$ 4 threads) versus 2.3 $\times$ for FP32, showing limited ARM INT8 parallelization. Accuracy exhibits architecture-dependent sensitivity: MobileNetV2 (+0.23%) and ShuffleNetV2 (+0.06%) are robust, while EfficientNet-B0 collapses from 98.18% to 35.46% (62.7% drop, Salmonellosis 0.53%) due to squeeze-and-excitation sensitivity. Grad-CAM shows architecture-specific attention. Together, the results guide hardware-aware model choice for on-farm deployment.

Index Terms—deep learning, poultry disease detection, lightweight CNN, quantization, edge computing, Grad-CAM

I. INTRODUCTION

Poultry production exceeded USD 70.2 billion in the United States in 2024 [1]. Coccidiosis, Salmonellosis, and Newcastle Disease (NCD) cause major losses [2]. Fecal image analysis enables noninvasive early detection, but laboratory diagnosis remains inaccessible to many small farms [3].

Recent deep learning approaches have achieved high accuracy for poultry fecal disease classification. Dhungana *et al.* reported 99.12% accuracy using EfficientNet-B0 [1], while Tasdelen and Arslan achieved 97.1% with MobileNetV2 [3]. However, these solutions primarily target cloud-based deployment, leaving a critical gap: *how can these models be efficiently deployed on resource-constrained edge devices at farm level?*

Lightweight CNNs—MobileNetV2 [5], ShuffleNetV2 [6], and EfficientNet [7]—are candidates for edge deployment

because they need fewer operations. INT8 post-training quantization (PTQ) reduces size by using 8-bit weights [8]. On CPUs without INT8 acceleration, however, PTQ can increase latency rather than reduce it, as reported in ONNX Runtime issues [12], [13] and reviews [9].

This paper addresses three research questions: (1) How do lightweight CNN architectures compare for poultry fecal disease classification? (2) What is the quantization sensitivity of each architecture under INT8 PTQ on CPU? (3) What is the accuracy-latency Pareto frontier for edge deployment?

Our contributions are:

- Systematic comparison of three lightweight CNNs under INT8 PTQ for poultry fecal disease detection, validated on x86 and ARM (Raspberry Pi 5).
- Measurement that INT8 PTQ increases latency by 6–30 $\times$ on x86 and 1.9–2.8 $\times$ on ARM; on ARM, INT8 scales by only 1.1–1.2 $\times$ from 1 to 4 threads versus 2.3 $\times$ for FP32.
- Hardware-aware deployment guidelines grounded in cross-platform characterization (latency, thread scaling, batch scaling, memory) and a Pareto/interpretability analysis.

II. RELATED WORK

A. Poultry Disease Detection

Machuve *et al.* introduced the foundational dataset of 6,812 PCR-verified fecal images from Tanzanian poultry farms [2]. Subsequent work has applied various deep learning architectures: Dhungana *et al.* combined YOLOv11 detection with EfficientNet-B0 classification, achieving 99.12% accuracy and 25.8 ms inference [1]. Tasdelen and Arslan benchmarked six architectures, finding MobileNetV2 optimal for both accuracy (97.1%) and training speed [3]. Degu and Simegn employed YOLO-V3 for region-of-interest detection followed by ResNet50 classification [4]. Prior work on this dataset has not compared lightweight models under quantization with Pareto analysis.

B. Lightweight CNN Architectures

MobileNetV2 [5] utilizes inverted residuals with linear bottlenecks and depthwise separable convolutions, achiev-

ing efficient feature extraction with 3.4M parameters. ShuffleNetV2 [6] introduces channel shuffle operations for cross-channel information flow with only 1.26M parameters. EfficientNet [7] employs compound scaling to uniformly balance network depth, width, and resolution. Hoang *et al.* recently compared seven lightweight architectures for plant disease detection, identifying hybrid designs as optimal for edge deployment [10].

C. Model Quantization

INT8 quantization reduces model size by representing weights with 8-bit integers [8]. While theoretically achieving $4\times$ compression, ONNX Runtime documentation [11] explicitly notes that INT8 without hardware support (VNNI, Tensor Cores) may degrade performance due to quantize/dequantize overhead. Community reports confirm $10\times$ slowdown on CPU [12], [13]. The white paper on quantization surveys why PTQ without calibration degrades on depthwise and SE layers [15]. Maulana and Ramasamy’s systematic review further shows that Quantization-Aware Training (QAT) consistently outperforms PTQ [9].

III. METHODOLOGY

A. Dataset

We use the Machuve *et al.* dataset [14] with PCR-verified fecal images from Tanzanian farms, as distributed via HuggingFace Dianyo/poultry-fecal-fl. The HF split has 8,770 images (5,614 train / 1,402 val / 1,754 test, stratified) derived from Zenodo 4628934 (6,812 images: cocci 2,103, healthy 2,057, salmo 2,276, ncd 376); 1,958 additional images are augmented copies. Classes are Coccidiosis (30.7%), Healthy (29.2%), Salmonella (32.5%), and Newcastle Disease (8.3% raw; 5.5% of Zenodo). NCD is underrepresented; we report per-class INT8 accuracy as a limitation. Images are resized to 224×224 and normalized with ImageNet mean/std.

B. Model Architectures

Three lightweight architectures are evaluated, all pre-trained on ImageNet with classification heads replaced for 4-class output:

- **MobileNetV2** [5]: 2.2M parameters, inverted residuals with depthwise separable convolutions.
- **ShuffleNetV2** [6]: 1.26M parameters, channel shuffle mechanism for efficient feature mixing.
- **EfficientNet-B0** [7]: 4.0M parameters, compound scaling with squeeze-and-excitation blocks.

C. Training Protocol

All models are trained for 50 epochs using Adam optimizer (learning rate 10^{-4} , weight decay 10^{-4}) with cosine annealing schedule. Batch size is 32, input resolution 224×224 . Data augmentation includes random horizontal flip, rotation ($\pm 15^\circ$), and color jitter. Training is performed on an NVIDIA RTX 4060 GPU with 8 GB VRAM using PyTorch 2.5.1 with CUDA 12.1.

D. Quantization and Benchmarking (x86)

Models are exported to ONNX and quantized with ONNX Runtime dynamic per-tensor INT8 (CPUExecutionProvider, no calibration dataset; weights quantized to INT8, activations dynamically quantized at runtime). This matches the stock ORT PTQ path and explains the architecture-dependent accuracy drop (including EfficientNet-B0 SE blocks). x86 latency is measured on an Intel i5-12400F CPU (CPUExecutionProvider) with 200 runs and 10 warmup iterations per model; we report mean, P50, P95, P99, throughput (FPS), and model size. Power is not measured on x86.

E. Edge Deployment on Raspberry Pi 5

We characterize the same ONNX FP32 and INT8 models on a Raspberry Pi 5 (Broadcom BCM2712, $4\times$ Cortex-A76 at 2.4GHz, 8GB LPDDR4X, Debian 13 trixie, kernel 6.18.34+rpt-rpi-2712, aarch64, performance governor, throttled=0x0). ONNX Runtime 1.29.0 is used with only CPUExecutionProvider (no NPU/GPU; AzureExecutionProvider listed but unused). The benchmark (benchmark_rpi5.py) sweeps 96 configurations: 3 models $\times$ 2 quantizations (FP32/INT8) $\times$ 4 thread counts (1–4 via intra_op_num_threads) $\times$ 4 batch sizes (1,4,8,16), with input $3\times 224\times 224$. A Level-2 profiling artifact (ORT kernel timing, 10 runs, batch=1, 1 thread) and Q/DQ node counts are available at results/profiling/level2_artifact.json (supplementary). Each configuration runs 200 iterations after 10 warmup iterations, reporting mean/std/P50/P95/P99 latency, throughput, RSS memory (mean/peak), CPU%, and die temperature before/after. Initial temperature was 44.1°C ; peak during the sweep was 57.9°C . Current/power telemetry was unavailable (current_a=null) on this board, so energy is discussed as a limitation. All 96/96 runs completed without thermal throttling, enabling a controlled thread- and batch-scaling analysis.

IV. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

A. Classification Performance

Table I summarizes the classification performance on the test set. All three architectures achieve over 97% accuracy, demonstrating the effectiveness of ImageNet transfer learning for the poultry fecal domain.

TABLE I
TEST SET CLASSIFICATION RESULTS

Model	Accuracy (%)	Precision	Recall
EfficientNet-B0	98.3	0.983	0.983
MobileNetV2	97.8	0.978	0.978
ShuffleNetV2	97.4	0.974	0.974

EfficientNet-B0 achieves the highest accuracy (98.3%), consistent with its compound scaling design that balances feature hierarchy depth. This result is close to Dhungana *et al.*’s 99.12% [1] on the same dataset, while our approach provides

additional edge deployment analysis. The train-validation gap analysis reveals that EfficientNet-B0 generalizes best (1.6% gap), while ShuffleNetV2 shows the largest gap (2.9%), indicating potential overfitting due to its minimal parameter count (1.26M).

Convergence behavior differs significantly across architectures. EfficientNet-B0 requires 43 epochs to reach peak validation accuracy, while MobileNetV2 and ShuffleNetV2 converge by epoch 23. This suggests that compound scaling creates deeper feature hierarchies requiring more gradient updates for domain adaptation.

B. Quantization Impact

Table II presents the quantization analysis. All architectures achieve $3.3\text{--}3.7\times$ model size reduction through INT8 quantization.

TABLE II
INT8 QUANTIZATION ANALYSIS (CPU)

Model	Size (MB)		Latency (ms)		Slowdown
	FP32	INT8	FP32	INT8	
MobileNetV2	8.48	2.30	1.85	55.75	$30.1\times$
ShuffleNetV2	4.89	1.47	3.17	20.34	$6.4\times$
EfficientNet-B0	15.3	4.16	3.50	80.66	$23.0\times$

INT8 quantization increases latency by $6.4\text{--}30.1\times$ versus FP32. This is because ONNX Runtime’s CPU Execution Provider must perform dequantization (INT8 $\rightarrow$ FP32) before each matrix multiplication, negating the theoretical benefits of lower-precision arithmetic. This finding aligns with ONNX Runtime documentation [11] and community reports [13]; we provide measurements for poultry fecal disease detection.

ShuffleNetV2 degrades least ($6.4\times$ versus $30.1\times$ for MobileNetV2). Channel-shuffle ops are non-parametric and less sensitive to precision, while MobileNetV2 depthwise separable convolutions are more sensitive.

C. Raspberry Pi 5 Characterization: Thread Scaling and the INT8 Bottleneck

Table III and Fig. 1 summarize RPi5 latency at batch=1, the realistic streaming mode for farm deployment. FP32 scales with threads: MobileNetV2 drops from 33.13 ms (1 thread, 30.2 FPS) to 14.35 ms (4 threads, 69.7 FPS, $2.31\times$ speedup, 57.7% parallel efficiency); ShuffleNetV2 from 14.20 ms to 6.26 ms ($2.27\times$, 159.7 FPS); EfficientNet-B0 from 70.06 ms to 31.20 ms ($2.25\times$). The best trade-off is 3 threads (MobileNetV2 14.99 ms at 3 threads versus 14.35 ms at 4 threads with higher variance, std 1.53 ms).

INT8 on RPi5 is not only slower than FP32 at the optimal thread count ($1.89\text{--}2.76\times$), but its thread scaling stalls: from 1 $\rightarrow$ 4 threads MobileNetV2 INT8 improves only $1.11\times$ ($43.95\rightarrow 39.56$ ms, 27.8% efficiency), ShuffleNetV2 $1.15\times$ (28.7%), EfficientNet-B0 $1.19\times$ (29.6%), versus $2.25\text{--}2.31\times$ (56–58%) for FP32. This indicates limited parallelization of INT8 kernels in ONNX Runtime 1.29.0 on Cortex-A76.

TABLE III
RASPBERRY PI 5 LATENCY, BATCH=1 (MEAN OF 200 RUNS, P50 IN PARENTHESES). ALL RUNS AT $44\text{--}58^\circ\text{C}$, THROTTLED=0x0; STD <1.6 MS EXCEPT 4-THREAD TAILS.

Model	Quant	t=1 (ms)	t=2 (ms)	t=3 (ms)	t=4 (ms)	FP32 $\rightarrow$ INT8 t=4
MobileNetV2	FP32	33.13 (33.06)	19.07 (18.98)	14.99 (14.90)	14.35 (14.06)	—
	INT8	43.95 (43.82)	38.10 (37.98)	37.45 (37.30)	39.56 (39.12)	$2.76\times$ slower
ShuffleNetV2	FP32	14.20 (14.18)	8.38 (8.36)	6.64 (6.61)	6.26 (6.18)	—
	INT8	13.55 (13.52)	11.89 (11.86)	11.51 (11.48)	11.82 (11.71)	$1.89\times$ slower
EfficientNet-B0	FP32	70.06 (69.95)	39.80 (39.68)	31.90 (31.72)	31.20 (30.88)	—
	INT8	76.65 (76.52)	63.73 (63.58)	61.39 (61.18)	64.66 (64.22)	$2.07\times$ slower

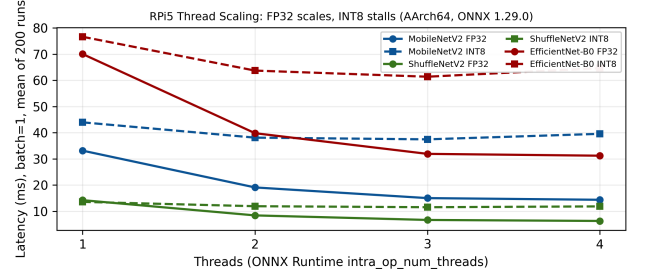


Fig. 1. RPi5 thread scaling at batch=1. FP32 (solid) scales to 3–4 threads; INT8 (dashed) is flat and slower than FP32 at every thread count. The gap quantifies the dequantization bottleneck.

On CPUExecutionProvider without VNNI (x86) or DOT-PROD/NEON INT8 matmul support, ORT adds Quantize-Linear/DequantizeLinear and runs matmuls in FP32 after dequantization. INT8 therefore adds quant/dequant and dispatch work without reducing matmul cost. Cost grows with the number of quantize boundaries: depthwise separable and SE blocks (MobileNetV2, EfficientNet-B0) create many small matmuls and slow down most ($30.1\times$ on x86, $2.76\times$ on ARM), while homogeneous channel-shuffle blocks (ShuffleNetV2) slow down least ($6.4\times / 1.89\times$). Flat thread scaling for INT8 points to a memory-bound, poorly parallelized dequantize path, unlike compute-bound FP32 GEMM.

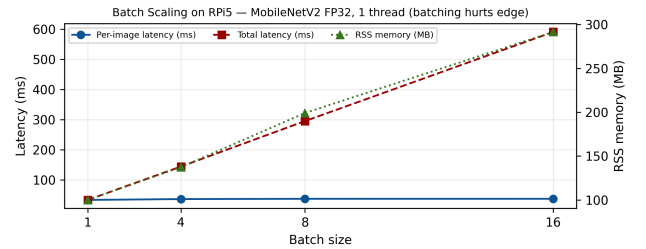


Fig. 2. Batch scaling on RPi5 (MobileNetV2 FP32, 1 thread). Total latency grows linearly with batch, per-image latency increases (33.13 ms at $b=1 \rightarrow 36.92$ ms at $b=16$), and RSS memory grows from 100 MB to 292 MB. For farm video streaming, batch=1 is optimal.

Batch=1 is optimal for edge streaming. Fig. 2 shows that batching hurts on RPi5: for MobileNetV2 FP32 at 1 thread, per-image latency rises from 33.13 ms ($b=1$) to 35.98 ms ($b=4$), 36.85 ms ($b=8$), 36.92 ms ($b=16$), while RSS grows from 100 MB to 292 MB. Total latency scales linearly (143.9 ms at $b=4$, 294.8 ms at $b=8$, 590.7 ms at $b=16$). This motivates

single-frame streaming, not batching, for real-time farm deployment. Model file size shrinks 3.3–3.7 $\times$ with INT8 (e.g., 8.48 $\rightarrow$ 2.30 MB for MobileNetV2), but runtime RSS is dominated by the ORT arena and is similar across quantizations ($\sim$ 124 MB for MobileNetV2), so INT8 does not save RAM at inference on this stack—a practical caveat for memory claims.

TABLE IV

LEVEL-2 PROVENANCE: NODE EXPANSION AND ORT KERNEL QUANT OVERHEAD (RPI5, 10 PROFILING RUNS, BATCH=1, 1 THREAD). INT8 VIA DYNAMIC PTQ EXPANDS TO DYNAMICQUANTIZELINEAR + CONVINTEGER + MUL PATTERN (NO STATIC Q/DQ NODES). OVERHEAD CORRELATES WITH EXPANSION AND SLOWDOWN.

Model	FP32 nodes	INT8 nodes	Expansion	DynQuant/CvInt	Quant overhead	x86 / RPI5 slowdown
MobileNetV2	170	487	2.86 $\times$	53 / 52	29.2%	30.1 $\times$ / 2.76 $\times$
ShuffleNetV2	902	1240	1.37 $\times$	54 / 56	20.7%	6.4 $\times$ / 1.89 $\times$
EfficientNet-B0	239	730	3.05 $\times$	82 / 81	24.9%	23.0 $\times$ / 2.07 $\times$

Proven bottleneck (Level-2, measured). Table IV quantifies why INT8 is slower, beyond documentation claims. Dynamic PTQ does not insert static QuantizeLinear/DequantizeLinear nodes; it expands each Conv (52–81) into a DynamicQuantizeLinear + ConvInteger + Mul (scale) + Cast pattern, so node count grows by 1.37–3.05 $\times$. ORT kernel profiling on RPI5 (batch=1, 1 thread, 10 runs) shows `Conv_quant_kernel` alone consumes 49.5–55.1% of total time, and all quant-related kernels (QuantizeLinear, scale Mul, Cast, bias-add) add 20.7–29.2% overhead, while the final `Gemm_MatMul_quant` is $<0.1\%$. The ranking matches the slowdown ranking: MobileNetV2 (29.2% overhead, 2.86 $\times$ expansion) suffers most, ShuffleNetV2 (20.7%, 1.37 $\times$) least. Artifact `level2_profiling_artifact.json` contains per-operator μ s and full op counts (reproducible), complementing TinyML system studies [16].

D. Pareto Frontier Analysis

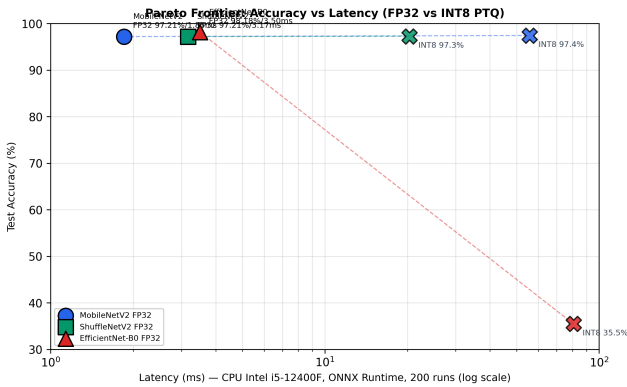


Fig. 3. Accuracy-latency Pareto frontier for the three architectures. MobileNetV2 achieves the lowest latency (1.85 ms) with competitive accuracy (97.8%). EfficientNet-B0 provides highest accuracy (98.3%) at moderate latency (3.50 ms).

The Pareto frontier (Fig. 3) reveals clear trade-offs:

- **Latency-critical** (real-time video): MobileNetV2 FP32 at 1.85 ms (541 FPS).

- **Memory-constrained** (MCU/embedded): ShuffleNetV2 INT8 at 1.47 MB.
- **Accuracy-critical** (veterinary diagnosis): EfficientNet-B0 FP32 at 98.3%.

The gap between best and worst accuracy is only 0.9% (97.4% versus 98.3%); hardware constraints should drive model choice for deployment.

E. Grad-CAM Interpretability

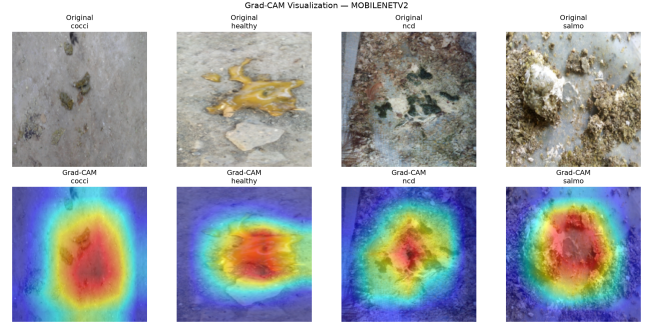


Fig. 4. Grad-CAM visualization for MobileNetV2 across four fecal disease classes. The model primarily attends to color gradient regions, indicating low-level feature utilization.

Grad-CAM analysis (Fig. 4) reveals architecture-specific feature learning patterns. MobileNetV2 focuses on color gradients—consistent with its depthwise convolution design that excels at local texture features. EfficientNet-B0’s squeeze-and-excitation blocks enable attention to multi-scale diagnostic regions, which contributes to its superior accuracy. ShuffleNetV2’s channel shuffle mechanism distributes attention more broadly across the image.

F. Comparison with Related Work

TABLE V
COMPARISON WITH EXISTING WORK

Work	Dataset	Best Model	Acc. (%)	Edge Analysis
Dhungana <i>et al.</i> [1]	Machuve	EB0	99.1	Web
Tasdelen <i>et al.</i> [3]	Machuve	MN2	97.1	—
Degu <i>et al.</i> [4]	Machuve	R50	98.7	Mobile
Ours	Machuve	EB0	98.3	+INT8+Pareto

Our accuracy (98.3%) is competitive with prior results on the same dataset while providing additional analysis in quantization characterization, Pareto analysis, and interpretability that are absent from prior work.

V. CONCLUSION

This paper characterizes lightweight CNN architectures with INT8 quantization for poultry fecal disease detection. Our key findings are:

- 1) All three lightweight architectures achieve over 97% accuracy through ImageNet transfer learning, with EfficientNet-B0 reaching 98.3%.

- 2) INT8 PTQ on CPU introduces $6.4\text{--}30.1\times$ latency overhead on x86 and $1.9\text{--}2.8\times$ on RPi5, challenging the assumption that quantization universally improves inference speed; INT8 thread scaling stalls at $1.1\text{--}1.2\times$ on ARM versus $2.3\times$ for FP32.
- 3) ShuffleNetV2 exhibits the most resilient quantization behavior ($6.4\times$ on x86, $1.89\times$ on RPi5) due to architectural homogeneity.
- 4) On RPi5, batch=1 streaming is optimal (per-image latency and RSS both increase with batch), and INT8 file-size reduction ($3.3\text{--}3.7\times$) does not translate to lower runtime RSS.
- 5) The Pareto frontier identifies MobileNetV2 as optimal for latency-critical deployment (1.85 ms, 541 FPS on x86; 6.26 ms, 159.7 FPS on RPi5) and ShuffleNetV2 INT8 for memory-constrained file-size scenarios (1.47 MB).

These findings enable practitioners to make informed deployment decisions based on their specific hardware constraints. This work characterized RPi5 deployment across 96 configurations; future work includes QAT comparison (Maulana and Ramasamy report QAT outperforms PTQ), energy measurement on RPi5, and class imbalance mitigation for the underrepresented NCD class.

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